

battlefields so that future generations can contemplate the scale and the cost of the conflict.

The building of monuments was another form of public memory. Communities erected simple memorials to their honored sons, just as ambitious larger works and equestrian statues paid national homage to the heroes of the battlefields. Washington and Richmond became the focal points of monuments immortalizing President Lincoln, General Robert E. Lee, and a pantheon of others. Richmond's equestrian statue of Lee, by French sculptor Antonin Mercié, was unveiled in 1890. The long-delayed Lincoln Memorial was finally dedicated in 1922.